was $105.55 billion on 2 January 2008, plummeted to $34.49 billion over a decade a decline of more than 67 per cent. When demand crimped, it adversely affected companies across the globe.

According to the *Financial Times*, 'From the US to Australia and Brazil to Japan, producers have buckled after prices fell by nearly 30 per cent' in 2015, and at 'companies such as ArcelorMittal, US Steel and Nippon Steel & Sumitomo Metal, earnings have crumpled, share prices sagged and, in some cases, thousands of jobs lost in response to a slump triggered by a massive international oversupply'. In comparison, through a combination of steps, the EBITDA of Tata Steel Europe in 2018 had risen to 53 per cent of its 2008 figure.

The question many ask, with the benefit of hindsight, is whether Ratan did right by acquiring Corus. Leng says, 'He brought in true internationalization. He is the custodian of the next generation. That aspect of his personality has not been nationally or internationally appreciated … He is a visionary beyond today.'

For the common Indian, Corus was an instance of pride reclaimed. 'Much of India erupted with jubilation', wrote *The New York Times*, adding that the new acquisitions spawned a 'new nationalism'. It quoted the brand director of a leading Indian media house as saying, 'We were eclipsed for a while, overtaken by foreigners and foreign rule for a few centuries, and this is a comeuppance that is deserved—the need for some retribution.'

The acquisition, through a fiercely fought bidding process, gave the Tatas access to new technology and knowledge of making specialized steel —'enabling Tata Steel and its senior managers to gain access to steelmaking technologies in Europe pioneered by Corus', including 'highly prized' steel for the auto industry, wrote the *Financial Times*. It also brought in important R&D, newer markets and management skills.

Recalling what Ratan always said, Hussain comments, 'We cannot live in our comfort zone. It is for the present management to get the ship into shape. If you cannot, then think of other options.'

The New York Times which foresaw a significant enhancement in the group's reputation on account of the acquisition, succinctly commented: 'Across much of the world, India is still thought of as a land of elephants and maharajahs. But one day, it might be known for Tata.'